

SCHOOL BASED PROJECT

Effects of Social Media on Students at Marondera High School

STAGE 1: Problem Identification

1.1 Description of the Problem

Social media platforms such as WhatsApp, Facebook, TikTok and Instagram are widely used by students at Marondera High School. While social media helps students communicate and access information, excessive use has negatively affected academic performance, concentration, discipline and social interaction among learners. Some students spend too much time online instead of studying, resulting in poor grades and lack of focus in class.

1.2 Brief Statement of Intent

The purpose of this project is to investigate the effects of social media on students at Marondera High School and to identify ways in which social media can be used responsibly to improve students' academic and social lives.

1.3 Design / Project Specifications or Parameters

1. To collect information from students through questionnaires and interviews.
2. To analyse both positive and negative effects of social media on students.
3. To suggest possible solutions that promote responsible use of social media.

STAGE 2: Investigation of Related Ideas

Related Idea 1: Social Media Improves Communication

Students use WhatsApp groups to discuss homework and share educational information.

Merits

- Enhances communication between students and teachers.
- Makes sharing of notes and assignments easier.

Demerits

- Students may become distracted by unnecessary chats.
- Some learners misuse groups for gossip and bullying.

Related Idea 2: Social Media Affects Academic Performance

Many students spend long hours on TikTok, Facebook and Instagram instead of studying.

Merits

- Educational videos help students understand difficult topics.
- Learners can access online learning materials.

Demerits

- Excessive use reduces study time.
- Students may fail to complete assignments on time.

STAGE 3: Generation of Ideas / Possible Solutions

Possible Solution 1: Awareness Campaigns

The school can organise workshops on responsible social media use.

Possible Solution 2: Controlled Study Timetables

Students can create personal study schedules limiting social media time.

Possible Solution 3: Educational Use of Social Media

Teachers can create educational WhatsApp or Google Classroom groups.

The proposed solutions are practical and can help students benefit from social media while reducing negative effects.

STAGE 4: Development / Refinement of Chosen Idea

Chosen Solution: Educational use of social media.

Justification of Choice

1. It allows students to use social media positively for learning purposes.
2. It improves communication between teachers and students regarding school work.

Refinements

- Creation of class WhatsApp groups strictly for academic discussions.
- Introduction of rules guiding appropriate online behaviour.
- Teachers monitor educational groups to ensure focus on academic matters.

STAGE 5: Presentation of the Final Solution

The final solution will be presented through charts, questionnaires, survey results, awareness posters and oral presentations explaining responsible use of social media. The presentation will clearly explain how social media can be used responsibly to improve academic performance and student behaviour.

USE SOCIAL MEDIA WISELY!
Think Before You Post
Balance Social Media and School Work
Avoid Cyberbullying and Bad Content
Use Social Media for Learning and Research
BE SMART • BE SAFE • BE RESPONSIBLE

STAGE 6: Evaluation and Recommendations

Evaluation

The project successfully investigated the effects of social media on students at Marondera High School and identified ways to encourage responsible use of social media.

Challenges Encountered

- Some students were unwilling to provide honest responses.
- Limited access to internet resources during research.

Recommendations

1. Schools should educate students about responsible use of social media.
2. Parents and teachers should monitor students' online activities.
3. Students should balance social media usage with academic work.